SHRI RAM COLLEGE OF COMMERCE

#GTBharat

Grant Thornton

Grant Thornton CASEQuest

DIVERSITY, EQUITY AND INCLUSION

TEAM ELITE CONSULTANT



Sujal Agrawal



Umang Gupta

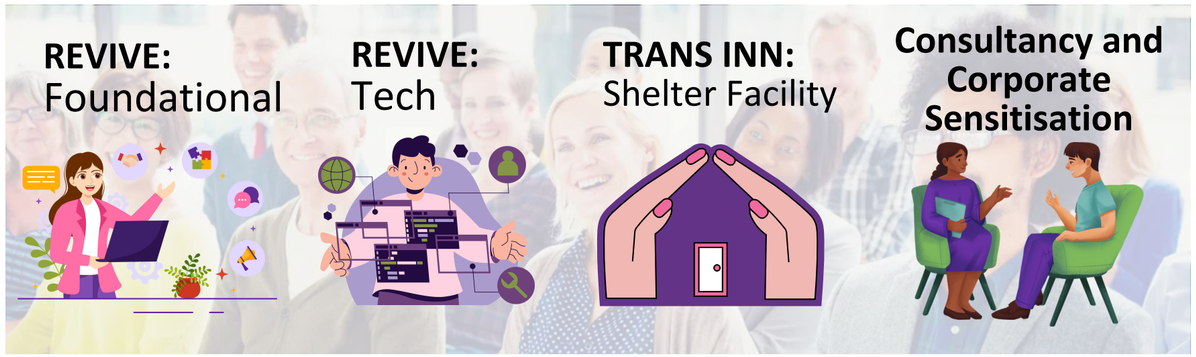


Muskan

CASE OVERVIEW - How can PeriFerry scale, deepen rural engagement, and create alternative livelihoods?

STATUS QUO

PROGRAMS:



IMPACT CREATED:

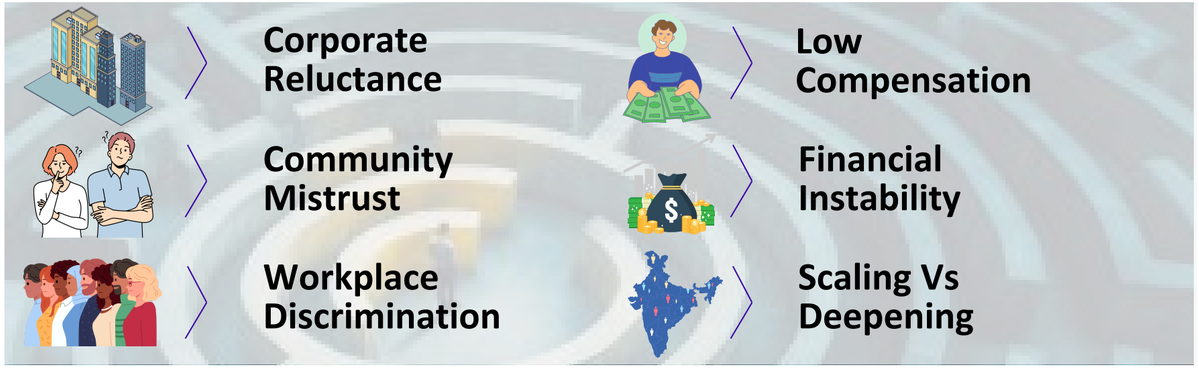
680+ Trans Persons Upskilled

510+ Trans Persons Employed

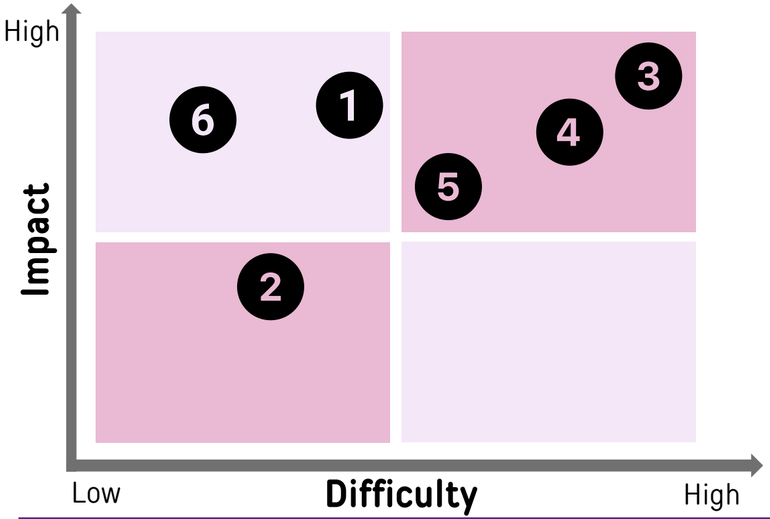
170+ Corporate Journeys Enabled

63K+ Employees Sensitised

CHALLENGES:



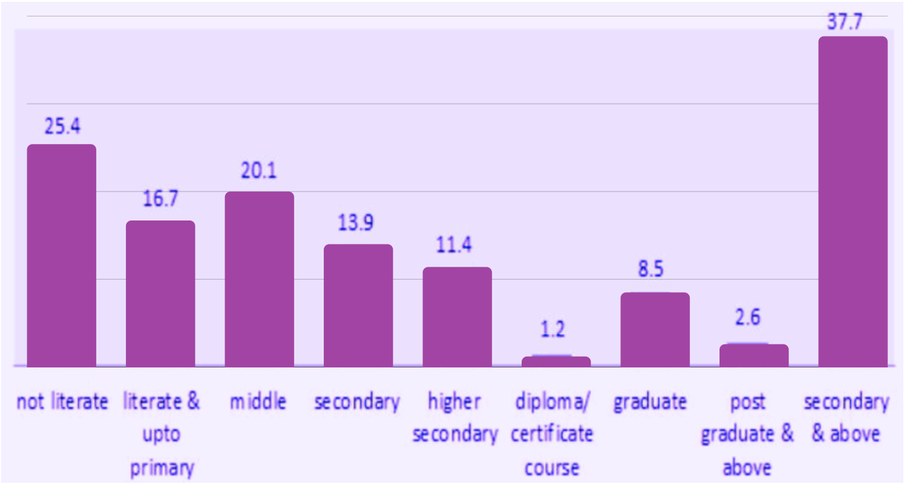
PRIORITISATION OF CHALLENGES

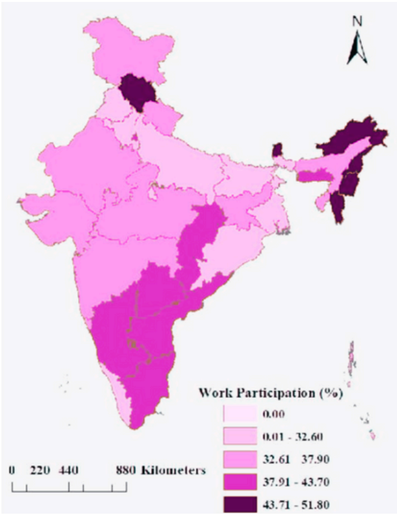


1. Corporate Reluctance
2. Community Mistrust
3. Workplace Discrimination
4. Low Compensation
5. Financial Instability
6. Scaling Vs Deepening

CURRENT SCENARIO

Level of Education among Transgenders (2018-19)





BRIDGING GAPS: EMPOWERING TRANS LIVES IN UNPRIVILEGED AREAS

RURAL ENGAGEMENT STRATEGY OVERVIEW

Pain Points in Rural Areas

1. **Education:** People there are **Less educated in general** and about **Inclusivity in particular**.
2. **Technology: Limited** access to **Technology** and **Reliable Internet** because of **cost** constraints & lack of **digital literacy**.

STRATEGY IMPLEMENTATION

Illustrating the process

Spark Dialogue

Educate and **engage** communities to **reduce stigma, build empathy**, and foster **inclusivity**.

Future Ready

Equip individuals with **essential skills** for **economic independence** and **personal growth**.

Engage Together

Foster **meaningful connections** for shared **experiences**, mutual **support**, and inclusive community **growth** and **empowerment**.

Shift Power

Empower communities through **leadership**, **mentorship**, and **sustainable support**.

1. SPARK A DIALOGUE : BUILDING AWARENESS AND CONSULTING

Purpose: To **tackle stigma** and **limited understanding** in rural areas, we **aim** to **educate** and **engage communities** for greater inclusivity.



COMBINING WITH LOCAL EVENTS

Hosting **Joint events** with **health camps, job fairs, and legal aid workshops** because people in whole of **India** and **Rural India in particular** are already **hesitant** and **might not show up** if its **exclusively** for LGBTQ+ .

TRANSGENDER SHELTER VISITS

We can organise **trips** to **our shelters** for transgender people. This **interaction and understanding** would allow people to be more **aware and empathetic**. Also the trans people would **not feel secluded** in the shelters.



Supplementary Mediums



Nukkad Naataks



Moving Vans



Canopy Tents

ESTABLISHING COLLABORATIONS

- **Government Programmes**
- **Corporate's CSR Initiatives**
- **NGOs and Local Leaders**

Source

BRIDGING GAPS: EMPOWERING TRANS LIVES IN UNPRIVILEGED AREAS

2. TRAINING THEM AND MAKING THEM FUTURE READY

PRE-RECORDED SESSIONS IN LOCAL LANGUAGES



Local Languages because there's **limited education** in rural areas and also it'll feel **more personal.** Because there's **limited technology**, we'll **record** videos and audio programmes and **project these** at the community resource centers.

Community Resource Centers: Dedicated spaces in rural areas with **Wi-Fi, program recordings, and tools**, addressing **limited technology access** locally.

Replicable Model of Audio & Video Formats: Cost-effective formats, **scalable** for rural reach, leveraging **popular mediums like radio** effectively.

HANDICRAFTS, ENTREPRENEURSHIP & FOLK MUSIC & DANCE



Along with the Business & Analytical skills, Linguistic Skills, Programming, etc. that we're **already doing**. We'll **also** focus on teaching and communicating some **handicraft** opportunities, **advanced agrictultural** practices, **showcasing their dances, music,**etc.

Promoting Entrepreneurship by providing training and small capital: Provide training and small capital, fostering **self-reliance**, enabling them to **create jobs for others** too.

Promoting their local crafts and their Music and Dances: Empower communities by **celebrating and promoting** their crafts, music, and traditional dances **globally**.

3. COLLABORATE AND ENGAGE

Executing a Buddy System

Buddy Pairing → **Experience Sharing** → **Community Bonding** → **Support in Action**

The buddy system pairs **urban & rural transgender** individuals, fostering **mental health** through **shared experiences**, **emotional support**, **resilience**-building, facilitated **engagement**, & **inclusive growth**.

Micro Credit

Business Skills and Mentorship

4. SHIFT POWER



Sourav: " I've **learned** so much with PeriFerry - now I want to **share this knowledge** with **others like me**! "

"Exactly! You're **the voice of change**. Let's equip you to **inspire** and **empower** our community." — periferry

Here's the deal:

Train **beneficiaries** as **peer mentors** to facilitate **workshops** and provide **ongoing support**, fostering **knowledge-sharing** & **leadership** within communities.

Create a **discrimination-free**, **inclusive environment** where mentors can work confidently, ensuring **financial independence** and **good income** opportunities.

Leverage **local connections** for **better understanding** and impact, building a **sustainable cycle** of empowerment that drives **long-term change**.



Community Ambassador

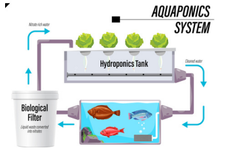
Empowering **local leaders** to drive change through **mentorship** & **advocacy**.

Source

ALTERNATIVE LIVELIHOOD MODELS FOR TRANSGENDER INDIVIDUALS

Aquaponics

Aquaponics integrates fish farming and ***plant cultivation in a closed-loop system, using 90% less water than traditional methods.*** It delivers 4-6 times higher yields per square foot and generates dual income from crops and fish.



Government Support: Subsidies and grants incentivize aquaponics systems, promoting water efficiency and ***dual revenue streams.***
Case Study - Gotham Greens (USA): **Generates ₹10,000-₹15,000 annually per 1,000 sq. ft.,** proving scalability and profitability.

Organic farming

Organic farming ***eliminates chemicals, relying on natural inputs like compost and manure, reducing costs while boosting profits.***



Government Support: NRLM provides skill training and market linkages, while NPOP certifies products for export, ***contributing to ₹12,000 crore organic exports in 2022-23.***
Case Study - Kashika Foods: ***Women-led SHG earns ₹12-15 lakh annually through organic spice production,*** demonstrating financial success and community impact.

Self-Help groups

Self-help groups (SHGs) are ***community-based collectives where LGBTQ+ individuals come together to tackle shared challenges,*** foster mutual support, and pursue financial independence.



Self-help groups (SHGs) enable LGBTQ+ individuals to generate income through ***collective businesses and access microfinance.*** They provide training, resources, and a supportive environment for economic independence.

FOSTERING LGBTQ+ EMPOWERMENT THROUGH INCLUSIVE ENTREPRENEURSHIP VENTURES



Handicrafts and Artisanal Products

- **Empowering Through Cultural Heritage:** Train transgender individuals to craft traditional products like textiles, jewelry, and decor.
- **Market Access:** Collaborate with online platforms and local fairs to sell products.



Content Creation Studios

- Provide workshops in **photography, video editing, and social media** management.
- Connect participants with **freelancing opportunities** on platforms like Instagram and YouTube.



Trans-Owned Cafés and Eateries

- **Inclusive Food Spaces:** Establish cafes or eateries managed by transgender individuals, fostering visibility and inclusivity.
- **Community Pride:** Use these spaces to host events that celebrate transgender culture and identity.



Community Wellness Centers

- **Wellness Programs:** Offer yoga, fitness, or counseling services led by trained transgender professionals.
- **Skill Development:** Partner with wellness organizations to certify individuals as trainers or therapists.



Social Media Content Creation

- **Storytelling Platforms:** Train transgender individuals to share their stories via YouTube channels or podcasts to show their unique perspectives



Food Businesses

- **Launch a food business inspired by stories like Nazia, a transgender entrepreneur** who started a cookie and jam venture. These initiatives highlight the potential of food businesses beyond corporate life.

Source

RAINBOW BREWs

"A true warrior, like tea, shows his strength in hot water"

- A resilient transwoman from Assam, forced to leave her studies due to bullying and but helped in her father's shop.
- She launched "Connecting Mitr," offering 250 tea blends, including aromatic, spicy, and health-focused varieties for issues like diabetes and high blood pressure.



Priyanka Sharma



Sustainable Brown Paper Packaging

@rainbow_brews

Key Metrices

Market Reach

- DELHI
- UP
- ASSAM
- MH
- HARYANA

30 % profitability

JAN - MAR

Total - INR 14170

KALAACKERY

" I shaped my identity the same way I shape terracotta – with patience, resilience, and a vision for something beautiful."

- Overcoming Challenges: Kunal, a 30-year-old trans man from Faridabad, Haryana, faced societal pressures and left home to pursue his identity.
- Craftsmanship: He excels in crafting terracotta crockery, with a talent for creating unique, customized designs.



Story of Kunal

Terracotta Crockery





@kalaackery

Key Metrices

Market Reach

- Delhi
- Gurgaon
- Mumbai
- Kolkata
- Siliguri
- Chennai
- Lucknow

50 % profitability

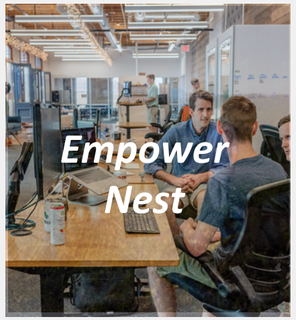
JAN to MAR

Total - INR 8820

Source

ENTREPRENEURIAL INITIATIVES & COMMUNITY-DRIVEN PROJECTS

TRANSFORMATIVE ENTREPRENEURSHIP & COMMUNITY SOLUTIONS



Empower Nest: Incubator for transgender entrepreneurs.

A nurturing incubator offering mentorship, funding, and resources to help transgender entrepreneurs build successful businesses.

500+ Entrepreneurs Supported

Benefits of the solution..

- **Economic Empowerment-** Enables financial independence for LGBTQ+ entrepreneurs.
- **Skill Enhancement** Provides valuable training and resources.



National LGBTQ+ business pitch competition

A national platform empowering LGBTQ+ individuals to pitch innovative ideas and secure funding for impactful ventures.

₹5 Crore+ Funding Raised

Benefits of the solution..

1. **Increased Visibility**
2. **Access to Funding**
3. **Mentorship Support**



Global LGBTQ+ freelancing platform.

A global freelancing platform connecting LGBTQ+ professionals with opportunities to showcase their skills and thrive.

10,000+ Global Freelancers

Benefits of the solution..

- **Global Networking**
- **Diverse Freelance Opportunities**
- **Career Growth**

Empower LGBTQ+ individuals through inclusive ventures like aquaponics, organic farming & entrepreneurship projects

VALUE PROPOSITIONS

1. PeriFerry will enables transgender individuals to launch businesses with mentorship, funding, and training in low-capital sectors.
2. Provides essential training in digital services, freelancing, and soft skills, empowering individuals for independent work.
3. Periphery will explore the transgender ecosystem to create local opportunities. High-potential areas like artisan products will boost entrepreneurship, with initiatives such as trans cafes in Delhi and Bangalore leading the way.

KEY PARTNERSHIP AND WAY FORWARD

PeriFerry can partner with ***TransWork*** to provide ***mentorship, networking,*** and certification for transgender entrepreneurs.

PeriFerry can collaborate with ***StartOUT*** to offer ***education, networking,*** and ***funding*** to LGBTQ+ entrepreneurs.

PeriFerry can collaborate with CDF to partner with ***transgender entrepreneurship*** and build a stronger, more inclusive community together

Source

DEEPEN VS EXPANSION - A DILEMMA SOLVED

PeriFerry should focus on deepening its presence in Chennai and Bengaluru rather than expanding to other cities at this stage.

Reason 1: *Strengthen Core Operations*

- PeriFerry has established trust and infrastructure in Chennai and Bengaluru, which can be further leveraged for greater impact.
- Focused efforts in familiar environments help address corporate reluctance, discrimination, and low wages.

Reason 2 : *Resource Constraints*

- PeriFerry, a social enterprise, is focused on consolidating operations in two cities to optimize resources.
- The enterprise aims to achieve financial sustainability through this consolidation before expanding geographically.

Reason 3 : *Existing Corporate Partnerships*

- Partnerships with ANZ Bank and Nestaway prove the success of sensitization and job placements.
- Strengthening these ties will drive higher retention, better wages, and expanded opportunities for transgender individuals.

Reason 4 : *Create a Proven, Scalable Model*

- By deepening operations in Chennai and Bengaluru, PeriFerry aims to address corporate reluctance, low retention, and workplace discrimination.
- This approach will help create a replicable, sustainable model that can be scaled to other cities in the future.

A PATH TOWARDS SUSTAINABLE FUTURE

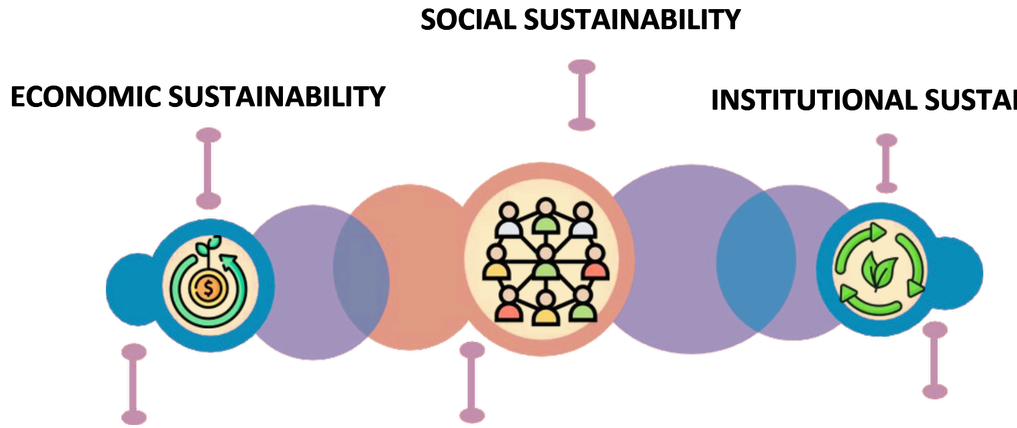
TIER 1 CITIES

Begin with cities like Delhi, NCR, Mumbai where corporate partnerships and inclusivity frameworks are more established, providing more employment in corporate corporations - which is the most sought after and feasible option.

TIER 2 & TIER 3 CITIES

Gradually expand to Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities, where corporate ecosystems and LGBTQ+ communities are growing, hence making the impact across India - not just limited to have who have geographical advantage.

DECODING THE BENEFITS



Increased Stability, Profitability, Scalability, Efficiency	Community Integration, Social Mobility, Inclusive Employment	Brand Reputation, Strong Governance, Strong Partnerships, Risk Management

EXPANSION STRATEGY IN THE LATER STAGE

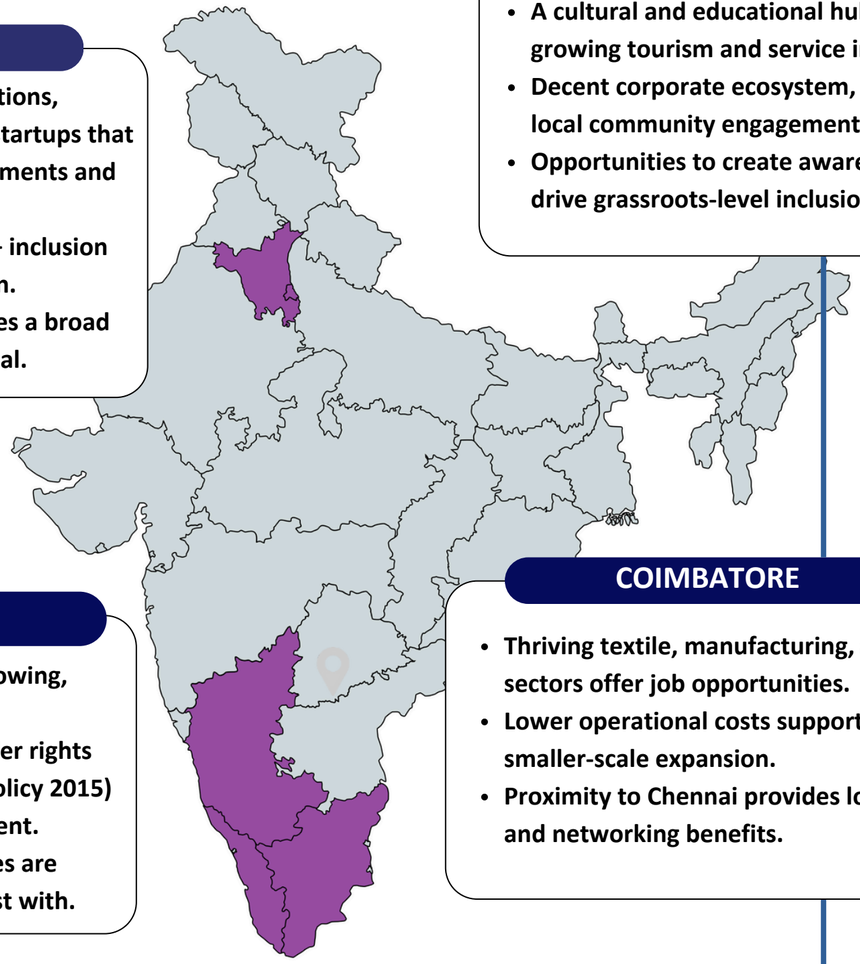
EXPANSION IN TIER 2 AND TIER 3 CITIES

DELHI, NCR

- Home to several large corporations, government organizations, & startups that can serve as partners for placements and sensitization programs.
- Growing awareness of LGBTQ+ inclusion among businesses in the region.
- High population density ensures a broad talent pool and impact potential.

MYSURU

- A cultural and educational hub with growing tourism and service industries.
- Decent corporate ecosystem, but strong local community engagement potential.
- Opportunities to create awareness and drive grassroots-level inclusion initiatives.



KOCHI

- IT and maritime sectors are growing, more job opportunities.
- Kerala's progressive transgender rights approach (e.g., Transgender Policy 2015) fosters a supportive environment.
- Smaller, close-knit communities are easier to engage and build trust with.

COIMBATORE

- Thriving textile, manufacturing, and IT sectors offer job opportunities.
- Lower operational costs support smaller-scale expansion.
- Proximity to Chennai provides logistical and networking benefits.

CRITERIA FOR SELECTION OF TIER 2 AND TIER 3 CITIES

Corporate & Industrial Presence	Select cities with multinational corporations, startups, and organizations investing in Diversity & Inclusion.
Lower Costs of Operations	Looking for the cities where expanding won't require a significant amount of investment, hence maintaining financial sustainability.
Community Accessibility	Regions with strong transgender or LGBTQ+ networks provide established platforms for support, advocacy, and easier community engagement.
Supportive Govt Policies	States with progressive policies for transgender persons ensure legal protections, inclusive workplaces, and access to essential services.

STRATEGIES TO EXAPND FURTHER

Running Pilot Programs	Starting by testing smaller-scale operations in one or two cities, such as Coimbatore or Kochi.
Community Partnerships	Collaborate with local NGOs, advocacy groups, and government bodies to establish a presence.
Sector-Specific Focus	Target industries that align with local economic strengths such as textiles in Coimbatore.

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Grand Thornton

Thank you

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